18.4 Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I keep seeing the explosion in my dreams." • "I jump at any loud sound." **Objective** • Nightmares and flashbacks • Hypervigilance • Jumps at sudden noise	**ACTUAL** **Post-trauma syndrome** related to exposure to a traumatic event as evidenced by flashbacks, nightmares and hypervigilance.	Within 2 weeks, fewer intrusive symptoms and uses grounding techniques.	• Keep his surroundings safe and predictable. • Listen, and never push him for details of the trauma. • Teach grounding and breathing techniques. • Give medication as prescribed. • Refer for trauma-focused therapy.	Uses the techniques, fewer symptoms: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I sleep 2 or 3 hours only." **Objective** • Exhausted • Irritable	**ACTUAL** **Disturbed sleep pattern** related to nightmares as evidenced by short sleep and irritability.	Sleeping better within 2 weeks.	• Good sleep habits. • A relaxation routine before bed. • If ordered, give the prescribed medicine for nightmares.	Better: **goal met**.
Subjective • "Sometimes I drink to forget." **Objective** • Drinking more	**RISK** **Risk for ineffective health self-management** as evidenced by risk factors: use of alcohol to cope with symptoms.	Can name safer ways of coping.	• Talk about how alcohol makes the symptoms worse. • Offer a referral to addiction services. • Bring in the people who support him.	Names his strategies: **goal met**.